INCH-POUND

A-A-53325A
30 April 1993

SUPERSEDING
A-A-53325
26 February 1988

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

ENVELOPE, STERILIZATION (Heat Seal)

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this Commercial Item Description

This Commercial Item Description describes combination paper/plastic sterilization envelopes suitable for use in steam and ethylene oxide sterilization, and closed by use of a heat sealer or sterilization indicator tape.

Salient characteristics:

The sterilization envelope shall be constructed of medical grade paper on one side and plastic film covering on the other side. The sides and one end of the envelope shall have a seal which shall remain intact before, during and after sterilization. The open end of the envelope is to be sealed by means of a heat sealer or pressure-sensitive adhesive tape of sufficient width to completely seal the envelope. Closure of the envelope shall be evident upon visual inspection of the seal. Exposure to steam or ethylene oxide shall in no way adversely affect the integrity of the seal.

Style A. Construction shall be white medical grade paper on one side and clear plastic film on the other side.

Style B. Construction shall be white or blue medical grade paper on one side and clear or blue tint plastic film on the other.

AMSC N/A FSC 6530

DISTRIBUTION STATEMENT A. Approved for public release; distribution is unlimited.

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The paper and plastic surfaces shall be sufficiently permeable to permit contents to be sterilized using steam and ethylene oxide, and sufficiently impermeable after sterilization so that contamination from the atmosphere shall not enter the closed envelope. The plastic surface shall permit easy product identification and shall be no less than 2 mils thick. Envelopes shall be specifically designed for containment of items during sterilization and aseptic handling and presentation after sterilization. Size of envelopes are approximate (± 1/2 inch (1.27 cm) and overall measurement is listed.

Size 1 - 4 inches wide X 8 inches long

Size 2 - 3-3-1/2 inches wide X 8 - 8-1/2 inches long

Size 3 - 6 inches wide X 10 inches long

Size 4 - 4 inches wide X 11 inches long

Size 5 - 7-1/2 inches wide X 14 inches long

Size 6 - 5 inches wide X 15 inches long

Size 7 - 16 inches wide X 16 inches long

Size 8 - 3-4 inches wide X 22 inches long

Each sterilization envelope shall have steam and ethylene oxide chemical indicators which shall provide visual indication that exposure to the sterilization process has occurred. The steam indicator shall not fully change color when exposed to ethylene oxide. The ethylene oxide indicator shall not fully change color when exposed to steam.

The envelope shall be free of tears, cuts, holes, perforations, grease, dirt or foreign matter.

Minimum marking shall include the company name and part number. Instructions and any other marking on the envelope shall be legible before, during and after sterilization.

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Workmanship. The sterilization envelope shall be free from defects which detract from its appearance or impair its serviceability.

Unit. Package (PG). One package containing one thousand sterilization envelopes of the style and size specified, constitutes one unit.

For Style A, Size 7. One package containing five hundred sterilization envelopes, as specified, constitutes one unit.

QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS.

Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

Records. Records of examinations and tests performed by or for the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made available to the Government upon request, at any time, or from time to time, during the performance of the contract and for a period of three years after delivery of the supplies to which such records relate.

Inspection. Inspection, as used herein, is defined as both examination (such as visual or auditory investigation without the use of special laboratory appliances or procedures) and testing (determination by technical means of physical and chemical properties) of the item.

Sampling for examination. Sampling for examination shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105, with an AQL of 0 (percent defective) and an inspection level of S-1. The unit of product for examination purposes shall be one package of envelopes.

Sampling for tests. Sampling for tests (dimensional), shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105, with an AQL of 2.5 (percent defective) and an inspection level of S-3. The unit of product for test purposes shall be one package of envelopes.

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Tests. Tests shall be conducted to determine compliance with specification requirements. Where feasible, the same sample shall be used for the determination of two or more test characteristics. Tests shall include, but shall not be limited to the following:

Steam Indicator Test. The steam indicator of the envelope shall change to the degree required by the instructions when exposed to a 3-1/2 minute prevaccuum cycle at 270°F (132°C) and a 20 minute gravity cycle at 250°F (121°C). No test failure shall be permitted.

Ethylene Oxide Indicator Test. The ethylene oxide indicator of the envelope shall change to the degree required by the instructions when exposed to standard 100% ethylene oxide cycle and to standard ethylene oxide/mixture cycle. No test failure shall be permitted.

Seal Strength Test. A test sample 1.0 inch wide by 2-1/2 inches long shall be cut from the envelope. The manufacturer's seal shall lie along one of the 1 inch edges. One of the flaps shall be lightly folded back against the seal to form a test specimen 1.0 inch wide by approximately 4-1/2 inches long. A tensile force of 350 grams shall be applied to the 1 inch ends of the envelope. The seal shall not fully part. If the seal fully parts, it shall constitute a defect.

Contractor Certification. The contractor shall certify and maintain substantiating evidence that the product offered meets the salient characteristics of this Commercial Item Description, and that the product conforms to the producers' own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices. The government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

Regulatory requirements.

Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act. If the product covered by this document has been determined by the U.S. Food and Drug Administration to be under its jurisdiction , the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act, as amended, and regulations promulgated thereunder. In addition, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of all other applicable Federal, State, and local statutes, ordinances, and regulations.

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Recovered material. The offeror/contractor is encouraged to use recovered material in accordance with Federal Acquisition Regulation Subpart 23.4 to the maximum extent practical.

Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking. Unless otherwise specified, preservation, packaging, and packing shall be to a degree of protection to preclude damage to containers and/or contents thereof under normal shipping conditions, handling, etc., involving shipment from the supply source to the receiving activity, plus reshipment from receiving activity, and shall conform to applicable carrier's rules and regulations. Intermediate and exterior package quantities and labeling and marking shall be as specified in the contract and/or order.

Ordering data. Intermediate/exterior package quantities, labeling and marking must be specified in the contract and/or order.

NOTES: The following National Stock Numbers are covered by this document:

NSN	Item Identification	Style	SIZE
6530-01-006-7323	ENVELOPE, STERILIZATION	A	5
6530-01-153-6358	ENVELOPE, STERILIZATION	A	1
6530-00-555-1880	ENVELOPE, STERILIZATION	A	2
6530-01-300-0903	ENVELOPE, STERILIZATION	A	3
6530-01-300-0906	ENVELOPE, STERILIZATION	A	4
6530-01-301-5321	ENVELOPE, STERILIZATION	A	6
6530-01-302-5094	ENVELOPE, STERILIZATION	A	7
6530-01-300-0910	ENVELOPE, STERILIZATION	A	8
6530-01-036-7486	ENVELOPE, STERILIZATION	B	1
6530-01-300-0905	ENVELOPE, STERILIZATION	B	2
6530-01-302-8304	ENVELOPE, STERILIZATION	B	3
6530-01-300-0909	ENVELOPE, STERILIZATION	B	5
6530-01-039-3788	ENVELOPE, STERILIZATION	B	8

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MILITARY INTERESTS:

Custodians:

Army-MD
Navy-MS
Air Force-03

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

DoD-MB

Agent:

DLA-DM

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITIES:

VA-OSS
USPHS
FDA-MPQAS

Project No. 6530-2407

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STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

INSTRUCTIONS

1 The preparing activity must complete blocks 1, 2, 3, and 8 In block 1, both the document number and revision letter should be given

2 The submitter of this form must complete blocks 4, 5, 6, and 7

3 The preparing activity must provide a reply within 30 days from receipt of the form

NOTE: This form may not be used to request copies of documents, nor to request waivers, or clarification of requirements on current contracts Comments submitted on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any portion of the referenced document(s) or to amend contractual requirements

I RECOMMEND A CHANGE:	1 DOCUMENT NUMBER	2 DOCUMENT DATE (YYMMDD)
	A-A-53325A	30 April 1993

3 DOCUMENT TITLE
ENVELOPE, STERILIZATION (Heat Seal)

4 NATURE OF CHANGE (Identify paragraph number and include proposed rewrite, if possible Attach extra sheets as needed)

5 REASON FOR RECOMMENDATION

6. SUBMITTER

a. NAME (Last, First, Middle Initial)	b ORGANIZATION	
c. ADDRESS (Include Zip Code)	d TELEPHONE (Include Area Code) (1) Commercial (2) AUTOVON (If applicable)	7. DATE SUBMITTED (YYMMDD)

8 PREPARING ACTIVITY

a NAME	b TELEPHONE (Include Area Code) (1) Commercial (2) AUTOVON
c ADDRESS (Include Zip Code)	IF YOU DO NOT RECEIVE A REPLY WITHIN 45 DAYS, CONTACT Defense Quality and Standardization Office 5203 Leesburg Pike Suite 1403, Falls Church, VA 22041 3466 Telephone (703) 756-2340 AUTOVON 289 2340

DD Form 1426, OCT 89 *Previous editions are obsolete* 198-290

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